

Learning objectives

After completing this project, you will be able to:

- Analyze the current processes of an organization to identify inefficiencies and areas for improvement.
- Develop a business requirements document (BRD) outlining the hospital's operational needs and improvement goals.
- Create a process flow (using Lucidchart) to visually represent current workflows and proposed optimizations.
- Propose solutions for process improvements by leveraging digital tools to enhance hospital efficiency, optimize resource allocation, and improve the patient experience.

Introduction

In this project, you will take on the role of a business analyst tasked with improving operations at a medium-sized hospital. The hospital is currently struggling with challenges such as patient management, outdated technology, and communication inefficiencies between departments.

You'll apply business analysis principles and tools to identify, assess, and recommend solutions for these issues. This project will give you practical experience in gathering requirements, conducting gap analysis, and utilizing tools like Lucidchart, Excel, and others for documentation and process improvement.

Instructions

This project represents the key tasks in a business analysis process:

- Project initiation and planning
- Requirements gathering and elicitation
- Requirements analysis and specification
- Solution design
- Implementation and change management
- Closure and final presentation

For each of these tasks, you will be creating one or more deliverables as action items.

The project deliverables can be created in a spreadsheet or table-based format (using a tool like Excel or Word). As part of the project, you are provided with a **Project Worksheet** (a

Word Document) with table-based templates for creating the deliverables.

For creating the process flow diagrams, you will need to use a diagramming tool, such as **Lucidchart**.

Download the Project Worksheet

Keeping the CTRL key pressed, click to download the [Project Worksheet](#) that provides tables to complete this assignment.

Note: Use the COMMAND key instead of CTRL on Mac systems.

Lucidchart for creating process flow diagrams

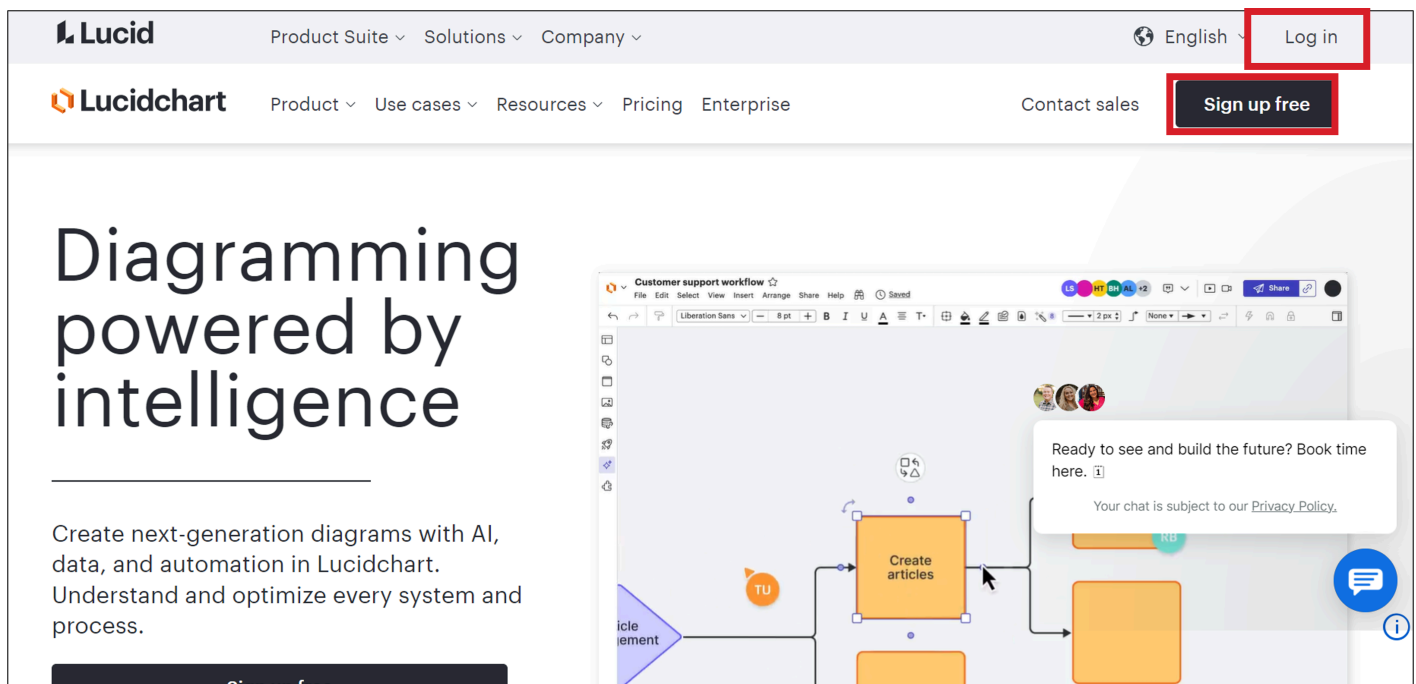
1. Click the following link to access the Lucidchart portal.

[Lucidchart | Diagramming Powered By Intelligence](#)

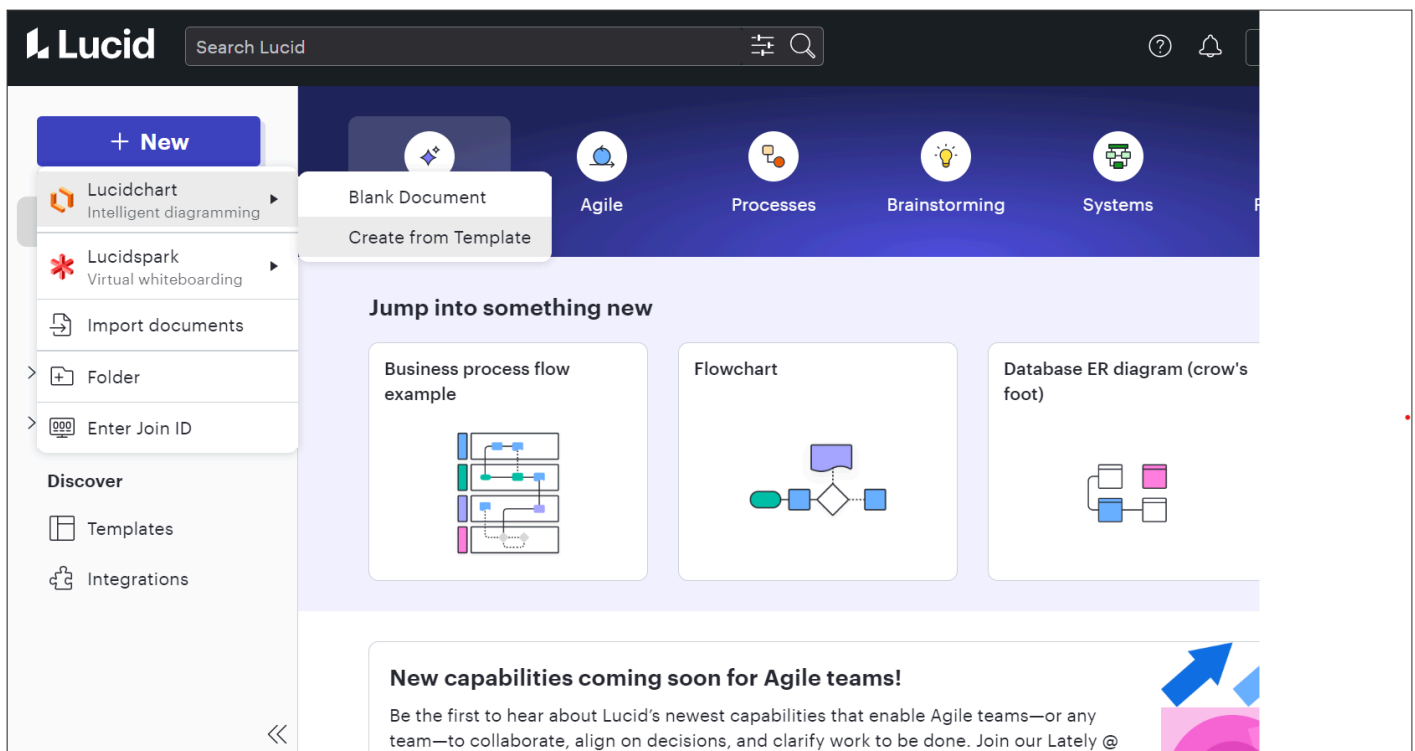
Note: If you cannot access the link, copy the following URL and paste it into the browser.

<https://www.lucidchart.com/pages/>

2. Sign up to create a free account and then log in.



3. Once logged in, you will navigate to the Lucidchart dashboard.



Task 1: Project initiation and planning

In this task, you will identify the key challenges of the hospital. You will define the scope of your analysis and the objectives of the project. You will also identify the key stakeholders of the project.

Step 1: Identify the problem

- The hospital is facing delays in patient management, outdated record-keeping systems, and inefficient communication between the departments (for example, admissions, doctors, and pharmacy).
- You will define the scope of the analysis and identify the core business problems.

Step 2: Stakeholder identification

- Identify key stakeholders, including hospital administration, doctors, nurses, IT department, and patients.

Create a **stakeholder analysis chart** in a spreadsheet or table-based format outlining their roles and their level of influence, interest, and involvement in the project.

Step 3: Define objectives and scope

- Define the project objectives, which include reducing patient wait times, improving communication between departments, and streamlining patient records.
- Establish the project's scope, including which departments and functions will be included in the analysis.

Deliverable for this task: Stakeholder analysis chart

Task 2: Requirements gathering and elicitation

Step 1: Conduct stakeholder interviews In this phase, business analysts create a list of questions for interviews with key stakeholders such as department heads, IT managers, and front-line staff. They use techniques like interviews to gather requirements and document the pain points and desired improvements for each department.

Step 2: Document requirements

- Project scope
- Stakeholders
- Objectives
- Functional and non-functional requirements, such as upgrading the hospital management system and ensuring compliance with healthcare regulations

Deliverable for this task: Business requirements document (BRD)

Task 3: Requirements analysis and specification

Step 1: Perform gap analysis

- Conduct a gap analysis to identify the differences between the current state (for example, manual records and delayed communication) and the desired future state (for example, integrated electronic medical record systems and real-time department updates).
- Document these findings as a gap analysis table.

Step 2: Prioritize requirements

- Prioritize requirements based on factors such as business impact, cost, and feasibility.
- Create a **prioritization matrix** or a simple table that ranks the importance of each requirement.

Deliverable for this task:

- Gap analysis table
- Prioritization matrix

Task 4: Solution design

Step 1: Develop process flows

- Using Lucidchart, create a **business process flow of the current state** for patient admissions and patient record updates.
- Develop a **process flow for the future state** that incorporates improved technology and communication systems. Highlight bottlenecks and how the proposed changes will address them.

Step 2: Conduct a technology assessment

- Conduct a **technology assessment** to evaluate the hospital's existing IT infrastructure and how it can be upgraded.
- Include suggestions for adopting electronic medical records (EMR) and integrating them with the hospital's existing systems.

Deliverable for this task:

- Lucidchart to represent the current state of business process flow
- Lucidchart to represent the future state of business process flow
- Technology assessment

Task 5: Implementation and change management (Optional)

Step 1: Suggest change management strategies

- Provide strategies for training hospital staff on the new systems and processes.
- Develop a change management plan to ensure a smooth transition to the upgraded systems.

Step 2: Risk management As part of the implementation and change management, a business analyst can identify potential risks, such as resistance to new technology or data security concerns. They propose mitigation strategies, such as offering comprehensive training and ensuring compliance with healthcare data regulations (HIPAA). This can be documented in a risk mitigation strategy document .

Deliverable for this task (Optional): Change management plan

Task 6: Solution evaluation

Step 1: Create metrics for evaluation

- Define success criteria for the project, such as a reduction in patient wait times by 20% or a decrease in communication delays between departments.
- Create a **dashboard** (using a spreadsheet such as Excel) that tracks these metrics.

Step 2: Stakeholder feedback In the solution evaluation phase, business analysts conduct a review session with key stakeholders to validate the proposed solution and gather feedback. Based on this feedback, they can update the BRD and process flows.

Deliverable for this task (Optional): Solution evaluation metrics

Task 7: Closure and final presentation

Step 1: Final documentation Before closing the project, the business analysts finalize the BRD, including any adjustments made during the stakeholder review. The analysts ensure that all process flows, gap analyses, and requirement prioritizations are documented.

Step 2: Present findings Prepare a final **presentation** that outlines the identified challenges, proposed solutions, and expected outcomes. You can include the slides outlining the key findings, proposed solutions, and business impacts.

- Slide 1: Introduction and project overview
- Slide 2: Problem statement and scope
- Slide 3: BRD
- Slide 4: Stakeholder analysis
- Slide 5: Gap analysis
- Slide 6: Current and future process flows (with diagrams)
- Slide 7: Prioritization matrix
- Slide 8: Technology assessment document
- Slide 9: Change management [Optional]
- Slide 10: Risk mitigation strategy document [Optional]
- Slide 11: Solution evaluation metrics [Optional]
- Slide 12: Conclusion

Compare your analysis to the solution

Keeping the CTRL key pressed, click to download the [potential solution document](#) .

Note: Use the COMMAND key instead of CTRL on Mac systems.

This document includes a sample solution for the deliverables in this project. Review, compare, and amend (if necessary) the deliverables you created.

Conclusion

This project equipped you with the skills to analyze and improve organizational processes within a hospital setting. By developing a Business Requirements Document (BRD) and creating process flows using Lucidchart, you identified key inefficiencies and areas for optimization. Through your proposed solutions, you can demonstrate how leveraging business analysis tools can enhance operational efficiency, streamline resource allocation, and ultimately improve the patient experience.